

CRIME INVESTIGATION - SUSPECT PROFILES

Case Reference: NGP-2026-FR-0058

Total Suspects: 11

Each suspect profile begins with 'SUSPECT: Name' as required by the Crime Investigation DSS.

SUSPECT: Sudhir Deshmukh

Sudhir Deshmukh, age 61. Chairman of the bank. Signed board resolutions approving the large loans without the mandatory credit committee minutes. Rs. 9 crore was traced to land purchases in the names of his wife and relatives. Absconding since 15 June with his phone switched off; a non-bailable warrant has been issued. Previous inquiry by the cooperative registrar in 2017 into irregular lending was closed without action. Directly instructed the peon to deliver files unopened. Primary beneficiary and central figure of the scheme.

SUSPECT: Anil Wankhede

Anil Wankhede, age 54. General manager who approved every one of the 63 loans and authorised the large cash withdrawals. Bank records show his personal account received Rs. 45 lakh in cash deposits over three years with no explanation. Was previously subject to a departmental inquiry for misconduct in 2015. Denies knowledge, saying he acted on the chairman's instructions. Has surrendered his passport but has not cooperated with the audit.

SUSPECT: Pooja Chitnis

Pooja Chitnis, age 35. Senior loan officer who prepared the loan files for most of the fictitious borrowers. Handwriting on the forged address proofs partially matches her. Core banking logs show her login was used to edit KYC fields after approval. Claims she was told the borrowers were 'special customers of the chairman'. Bought a flat valued at Rs. 60 lakh last year. No prior record. Cannot explain her edits.

SUSPECT: Mangesh Thakre

Mangesh Thakre, age 44. Private loan agent who recruited about 40 of the 63 shell borrowers and collected their signatures. Received commissions totalling over Rs. 30 lakh. Faced a cheating case in 2016 for an earlier loan racket, which is still pending trial. Says he only introduced customers. Two borrowers he introduced could not be traced at their listed addresses. No alibi relevant, but multiple witnesses named him.

SUSPECT: Farhan Ansari

Farhan Ansari, age 48. Empanelled property valuer whose reports inflated values by 3 to 5 times across all the sanctioned loans. Signed valuations for properties he never visited, per neighbours' statements. Received unusually high fees. Claims he relied on documents supplied by the bank. Registration with the valuers' association has been suspended pending inquiry. No criminal record.

SUSPECT: Rajendra Mahajan

Rajendra Mahajan, age 57. Chartered accountant who served as statutory auditor for three years and certified the loan books as clean. Did not conduct independent borrower verification. His firm received consulting fees from the bank that were double the usual rate. Says he relied on management representations. Professional body has issued a notice for misconduct. No criminal record.

SUSPECT: Vivek Kale

Vivek Kale, age 33. IT administrator who held the administrator login used to delete audit trail entries on two occasions. Says colleagues knew his password. Bank records show he received a two-wheeler and cash gifts from the general manager. Cannot explain the deletions. No prior criminal record. Knowledge of the scheme is uncertain but he actively concealed evidence.

SUSPECT: Sulochana Deshmukh

Sulochana Deshmukh, age 56. Wife of the chairman and registered owner of several land parcels bought with the diverted funds. Claims the properties were purchased from family savings. Has no role in the bank. Is cooperating with the Enforcement Directorate and has not absconded. No criminal record. Beneficiary of the proceeds.

SUSPECT: Priti Joshi

Priti Joshi, age 29. Bank cashier who processed large cash withdrawals on written instructions from the general manager. Followed procedure and retained the written instruction slips, which have now helped investigators. Received no unusual payments. Cooperating fully. No criminal record. Likely an unwitting participant.

SUSPECT: Ramesh Gaikwad

Ramesh Gaikwad, age 50. Peon at the bank who was told to deliver files unopened. Noticed the same photograph on different applications and passed a bundle of loan files to RBI inspectors, triggering the investigation. Cooperating and fully transparent. No financial irregularities found. No criminal record. A whistleblower rather than a participant.

SUSPECT: Shirish Pande

Dr. Shirish Pande, age 64. Independent director who recorded written notes of dissent against several loan approvals over two years and resigned in March in protest. His notes have been submitted to the investigators and match the irregularities found. No financial links to any borrower or the chairman. No criminal record. Fully cooperating and considered a key witness.